

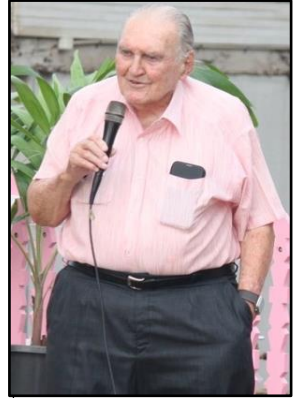


The Garamut
"The message sender"

**Ps Barry Reflections
from 'The WORD'!**
**For PRAYER,
PROCLAMATION &
PERSONAL PROGRESS**

Bethel Global Missions

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EXPANDING OUR PRAYER HORIZONS



OUR FOCUS:

In this reflection it is about expanding or broadening our perspectives of prayer.

Horizons.

1. A horizon in the physical sense is the line at which the earth's surface and the sky appear to meet. E.G. "the sun rose above the horizon".
2. But it is also the limit of a person's outlook, knowledge, experience, and in this reflection, it is about broadening our horizons in prayer.

In the physical sense the closer we move towards that horizon it moves/shifts out further and we can see further and see more than our original view.

It is in our moving forward towards those things that are before us (horizons) and the following are areas of our lives that always need expanding/enlarged.

- ★ Let us be strengthened and expanded in this area of our lives by continuing to explore and engage in PRAYER, IN all kinds of prayer.

Expanding our personal horizons in:

► PRAYER – expanding our prayer life.

- ★ Exploring new horizons of prayer that you may not have previously entered into opens up a new and broader concept of prayer and the things that it can accomplish. Venturing into new aspects of prayer. (*Praying always with all prayers and strong requests Ephesians 8:18*).

► INTERCESSORY PRAYER - that is formed, motivated and empowered by the Holy Spirit.

Romans 8:26-27 - Likewise the Spirit also helps in our weaknesses. For we do not know what we should pray for as we ought, but the Spirit. Himself makes intercession for us with groanings which cannot be uttered. - 27 Now He who searches the hearts knows what the mind of the Spirit is, because He makes intercession for the saints according to the will of God. NKJV

- ★ This is GOD through the Holy Spirit praying HIS prayers through us.
- ★ It is praying the kind of prayers that Jesus would pray if he were here in person on earth.
- ★ This could be a new horizon for you to venture towards and explore, opening up to you a new realm of prayer which you may not have experienced before.
- INTERCESSORY PRAYER - IS THE HOLY SPIRIT INSPIRED PRAYERS – prayers that are directly prompted and inspired by the Holy Spirit. It is not by our usual prayer list of things to pray for.
- ★ *It is praying in the Holy Spirit - Jude 1:20 – Ephesians 6:18 - 1 Timothy 2;1 – 1 Timothy 5:5 – Hebrews 5:7*

- PASSIONATE PRAYER, sincere (heartfelt). Prayer that is truly passionate and has intense feeling that involves our heart and causes us to personally engage and become part of what we are praying for. This is different to objective praying where we are detached from the persons or matter being prayed for.

- PETITION PRAYER, that strongly pleads and appeals to God on the basis of God's declared will and with Godly respect.

- ★ Like Jesus prayed in Hebrews 5:7 "Who in the days of his flesh, when he had offered up prayers and supplications with strong crying and tears unto him that was able to save him from death, and was heard in that he feared;" KJV "

- ▶ **DIRECTIVE PRAYING** – directed at a specific matter, objective or person. Prayer Involving the naming people, things, circumstances, and things that need God's miraculous intervention, speaking directly and authoritatively to that specific thing, clearly naming it.
- ▶ **FAITH FILLED PRAYER**, that is filled with strong and unwavering trust in what God has said. Investing your personal faith in that which you are desiring to see happen. Prayers that verbally expresses your faith in those things that God said he will do if we believe e.g. (*Mark 11: 23/24 Truly, I say to you, whoever says to his mountain, 'Be taken up and thrown into the sea,' and does not doubt in his heart, but believes that what he says will come to pass, it will be done for him. Therefore, I tell you, whatever you ask in prayer, believe that you have received it, and it will be yours*). ESV
- ▶ **PERSUASIVE PRAYER**, that persuades GOD on the basis of what God has already promised.
 - ★ **Like Abraham**, who pleaded with God to change his mind about destroying the righteous with the wicked in Sodom and Gomorrah; and God was persuaded by Abraham's appeal to Him. *Genesis 18:22-25 but Abraham remained standing before the Lord. - 23 Then Abraham approached him and said: "Will you sweep away the righteous with the wicked? - 24 What if there are fifty righteous people in the city? Will you really sweep it away and not spare the place for the sake of the fifty righteous people in it? - 25 Far be it from you to do such a thing — to kill the righteous with the wicked, treating the righteous and the wicked alike. Far be it from you! Will not the Judge of all the earth do right?"* NIV
 - ★ **Like Moses** who pleaded with God when he said he would destroy His people because they worshipped the golden calf, and through Moses prayerful intervention, the Lord relented from the disaster that he had spoken of bringing on his people. *Exodus 32:10-14*
 10 Now therefore let me alone, that my wrath may burn hot against them and I may consume them, in order that I may make a great nation of you."11 But Moses implored the Lord his God and said, "O Lord, why does your wrath burn hot against your people, whom you have brought out of the land of Egypt with great power and with a mighty hand?
 12 Why should the Egyptians say, 'With evil intent did he bring them out, to kill them in the mountains and to consume them from the face of the earth'? Turn from your burning anger and relent from this disaster against your people.13 Remember Abraham, Isaac, and Israel, your servants, to whom you swore by your own self, and said to them, 'I will multiply your offspring as the stars of heaven, and all this land that I have promised I will give to your offspring, and they shall inherit it forever.'"14 And the Lord relented from the disaster that he had spoken of bringing on his people. ESV
- ★ We can also learn to venture into this kind of praying; by holding up God's Word before him and reminding him what he has said or of his righteous character.
- ★ **This is a new horizon in prayer** that we can all move towards, explore and engage in.
- ▶ **STRATEGIC PRAYING**. This has to do with our prayers specifically and deliberately targeting those schemes and plans that are opposed or hindering God's plans and our ministry expressions.
 - ★ It is specifically directing our prayers towards those specific named targets or objectives that we have set for the advancement of the Lord's work.

Also, it is asking through prayer for God to show you logistically the new or next place to go, the specific persons that he wants you to meet /connect and speak to each day.
- ▶ **AUTHORITATIVE PRAYER**. Praying with the authority that has been delegated to us in Christ.
 - ★ Praying with the clear knowledge that we have the authority (the right) to demand, command, and to declare certain things that are right and good and must be done and according to God's will.
 - ★ Authority to bring pressure down on those things, circumstances that are resistant to normal prayer. This is not prayers of appeal but prayers demanding our God given rights.
- ▶ **REPETITIVE & PREVAILING PRAYER**, that keeps on asking, knocking, seeking, continuing until the answer comes (see Luke 18:1).
 - ★ Prayer that continues to press through UNTIL that prayer prevails.
 - ★ Prayer that prevails, perseveres and refuses to give up until it wins through!
- ▶ **CORPORATE PRAYER**, this is many individuals actively engaged in prayer together at the same time, having one heart (passion) and one mind (concept), for one purpose (Christ's cause).
 - Let all of us enlarge / broaden our prayer Horizons through prayer.
 - Let's explore new areas of prayer that we have never done before and seeing ourselves venturing further in what our new horizons of prayer may unfold for us.

Amen - Ps Barry